

★★★ SEALED ★★★

**DO NOT OPEN UNTIL YOU HAVE SUBMITTED YOUR
ANSWERS**

THE WRONG WIDOW — Solution packet

This packet contains the answer key and sealed exhibit D018. Keep it physically separate from the player case (own envelope / own print job / duplex break).

SEALED — DO NOT OPEN UNTIL SUBMITTED

★★★ SEALED — ANSWER KEY ★★★

Solved when A–D are supported from the **open** record set (D001–D017). D018 confirms motive/knowledge color only — it is not required to solve and is not the sole legal hinge.

Two layers (do not collapse them)

Recorded observation: what a document asserts (hospital “dead,” death register naming Lydia, 1866 “widower”).

Canonical truth: what happened (desertion; Martha’s marriage never dissolved; Lydia was lied to).

Element A: Supportable widow

Player must establish: Which claimant's marriage is the undissolved prior union that controls widow status

Answer: Martha Jane (Ashby) Corbett (person P002)

Basis: 1858 lawful marriage undissolved; Martha never remarried; prior spouse living through 1866–1887

Minimum exhibit citations: D005, D014, D012

Also helpful: D002, D009

Element B: Claimant beliefs

Player must establish: What each woman believed or asserted in her file (sincere vs knowingly false is a separate layer)

Martha: Asserts 1858 marriage + soldier's wartime death of disease; lives as widow on wartime word — marriage claim correct; death timing incorrect

Lydia: Asserts 1866 marriage + 1887 death as his widow; believes first wife died of fever (as told by Elias) — sincere on open evidence

Minimum exhibit citations: D002, D003

Also helpful: D004, D007

Element C: What happened

Player must establish: Soldier's wartime fate from conflicting military paper + postwar life

Wartime: Did not die in 1863; desertion / left convalescence after conflicting dead vs deserted paper

Postwar: Lived with Lydia in Jefferson until death 1887-02-14 pneumonia

Canonical death: 1887 only

Minimum exhibit citations: D007, D008, D010, D011, D004

Element D: Why both claims look real

Player must establish: Which documents legitimately support each file without collapsing 'record says X' into 'X happened'

Martha file supports: D005 early marriage; D009/D012 children + widow continuity; D014 no divorce; D007 wartime death word

Lydia file supports: D006 ceremony; D010/D011 long cohabitation Wife; D004/D013 death naming; D003 children

Teaching: Both documentary stories are real witnesses; only one is supportable under undissolved prior marriage

Minimum exhibit citations: D005, D006, D004, D014

Fail / incomplete if

- Picks widow solely because death certificate names her
- Conflates ceremony happened with marriage was lawful
- Treats a single muster/hospital line as definitive without addressing the conflicting roll + postwar life

Explicitly not required

- Every private motive
- Modern legal advice / full pension-law treatise
- Sealed ending document D018
- Knowing Elias's cruelty level beyond quiet new-life desertion

Proveable from open set (summary)

PRV01: 1858 Elias–Martha marriage exists and predates 1866 (*D005, D002, D009*)

PRV02: No divorce/dissolution located for Elias M. Corbett & Martha Jane Ashby (Ripley + Jefferson, 1858–1887) (*D014*)

PRV03: Martha never remarries (widow-head continuity 1870/1880 Ripley) (*D012*)

PRV04: Military paper conflicts: hospital dead-of-disease vs muster deserted/missing-supposed-dead (*D007, D008*)

PRV05: Elias appears alive postwar in Jefferson with Lydia (1870, 1880) — identity continuous via unit history + age/place/children cluster (*D010, D011, D006*)

PRV06: 1866 ceremony happened; Lydia lived as domestic wife until 1887 death naming her (*D006, D010, D011, D004, D013, D003*)

PRV07: Supportable widow = Martha; 1866 union unlawful though domestically real (prior spouse living + undissolved prior marriage) (*D005, D014, D012, D010, D011, D006, D004*)

PRV08: Each claimant's affidavit is understandable from her information set (Martha: wartime death word; Lydia: told first wife died of fever + lived marriage + death paper) (*D002, D003, D004, D007*)

PRV09: Wartime fate reconstructed: desertion after conflicting dead paper — not 1863 death (canonical death 1887 only) (*D007, D008, D010, D011, D004*)

★★★ SEALED EXHIBIT D018 ★★★

Confirmation only. Players who already adjudicated correctly should feel confirmation — not a new legal theory. Open-set proof already covers desertion trail (D008), postwar overlap (D010/D011), and no divorce (D014).

D018

Sealed — Benjamin F. Corbett affidavit (desertion + knowledge + lie)

Date: 1891-11-02 **Place:** Ripley County, Indiana

AFFIDAVIT

Affiant: Benjamin F. Corbett (brother)

Date: 1891-11-02

Place: Ripley County, Indiana

Affiant states under oath:

- Elias left convalescence and did not return to the regiment
- Elias knew Martha was living when he married Lydia
- Elias told Lydia his first wife had died of fever

Fictional facsimile for game use — not an authentic historical document.

End of sealed packet. This case resolves fully. Series appetite comes from craft and tone — not from withholding the answer.

SEALED — DO NOT OPEN UNTIL SUBMITTED